



BRAC University

Department of Mathematics and Natural Sciences

LECTURE ON

Real Analysis II (MAT321)

Topology of Metric Spaces

Open sets, Limit points and Closed sets

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CONDUCTED BY

Partho Sutra Dhor

Lecturer, BRAC University, Dhaka-1212

✉ partho.dhor@bracu.ac.bd | ✉ parthosutradhor@gmail.com

For updates subscribe on  [@ParthoSutraDhor](#)

Open and Closed Spheres

Open Sphere

Let (X, d) be a metric space and let $a \in X$. For any $r > 0$, the set

$$S_r(a) = \{x \in X : d(x, a) < r\}$$

is called an *open sphere* (or *open ball*) of radius r centered at a .

Closed Sphere

Let (X, d) be a metric space and let $a \in X$. For any $r > 0$, the set

$$S_r[a] = \{x \in X : d(x, a) \leq r\}$$

is called a *closed sphere* of radius r centered at a .

② Relation Between Open and Closed Spheres

Show that

$$S_r(a) \subseteq S_r[a]$$

for every $a \in X$ and for every $r > 0$.



Neighbourhood of a Point

Neighbourhood of a Point

Let (X, d) be a metric space and let $a \in X$. A subset $N_a \subseteq X$ is called a *neighbourhood* of the point a if there exists an open sphere $S_r(a)$ centered at a such that

$$S_r(a) \subseteq N_a$$

for some $r > 0$.

Open Neighbourhood

A neighbourhood N_a of a point a is said to be *open* if N_a is an open set in X .

② Open Sphere Is a Neighbourhood of Its Points

Show that every open sphere is a neighbourhood of each of its points.

Open Set

Open Set

A subset G of a metric space (X, d) is said to be *open* in X (with respect to the metric d) if G is a neighbourhood of each of its points. In other words, G is open if for each $a \in G$ there exists an $r > 0$ such that

$$S_r(a) \subseteq G.$$

❓ Illustrations of Open Sets

Show that each of the following subsets is open.



1. The empty set $\emptyset$ and the entire space X with any metric are open sets.
2. Every open sphere in a metric space (X, d) is an open set.
3. Let $A = \{z \in \mathbb{C} : 1 < |z| < 2\}$ with the usual metric. Then A is an open set.

4. Let

$$S = \{(x, y) \in \mathbb{R}^2 : x^2 + y^2 < 1\}$$

with the Euclidean metric. Then S is an open set.

5. Let

$$A = \{(x, y) \in \mathbb{R}^2 : y^2 < x\}$$

with the Euclidean metric. Then A is an open set.

6. Let

$$A = \left\{ f \in C[a, b] : \inf_{x \in [a, b]} f(x) > 0 \right\}.$$

Then A is open in $C[a, b]$ with respect to the supremum metric.

② Singleton Set in $\mathbb{R}$ Is Not Open

Show that on the real line with the usual metric, the singleton set $\{x\}$ is not open.

② Singleton Sets Under Different Metrics

Let $\mathbb{R}$ be the set of real numbers, d the usual metric and d' the discrete metric on the same set $\mathbb{R}$. Show that every singleton set $\{x\}$, $x \in \mathbb{R}$, is open in $(\mathbb{R}, d')$ but not open in $(\mathbb{R}, d)$.

② Discrete Metric Space: Every Set Is Open

Show that every subset of a discrete metric space (X, d) is open.



② A Subset Open in a Subspace

Let (X, d) be a metric space where $X = (0, 2)$ with the usual metric. Show that the subset

$$A = (0, 1)$$

is an open set in X .



💡 Basic Properties of Open Sets

In any metric space (X, d) ,

1. the union of an arbitrary family of open sets is open;
2. the intersection of a finite number of open sets is open.



② Intersection of Infinite Open Sets May Not Be Open

Show that the intersection of an infinite number of open sets in a metric space need not be open.

Limit Point

Limit Point

Let (X, d) be a metric space and let $A \subseteq X$. A point $x \in X$ is called a *limit point* (or *accumulation point*) of the set A if for every $r > 0$,

$$S_r(x) \cap (A \setminus \{x\}) \neq \emptyset.$$

② Illustrations of Limit Points and Derived Sets

Determine the set of limit points (derived set) in each of the following cases.

1. Let $X = \mathbb{R}$ with the usual metric and let

$$A = [0, 1).$$

Every point of A is a limit point of A , and 1 is also a limit point of A although $1 \notin A$. Hence

$$A' = [0, 1].$$

2. Let

$$A = \left\{1, \frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{3}, \dots\right\}$$

with the usual metric in $\mathbb{R}$. Then 0 is the only limit point of A and $0 \notin A$. Hence

$$A' = \{0\}.$$

3. If (X, d) is a discrete metric space, then the derived set of every subset of X is empty, that is,

$$A' = \emptyset \quad \text{for all } A \subseteq X.$$

4. Every real number is a limit point of the set of rational numbers $\mathbb{Q}$.
Hence

$$\mathbb{Q}' = \mathbb{R}.$$

5. The set of integers $\mathbb{Z}$ has no limit point, that is,

$$\mathbb{Z}' = \emptyset.$$

6. Every finite subset of a metric space has no limit point.

7. Let

$$A = \{z \in \mathbb{C} : 1 < |z| < 2\}$$

with the usual metric. Then

$$A' = \{z \in \mathbb{C} : 1 \leq |z| \leq 2\}.$$

Closed Sets

Closed Set

A subset F of a metric space (X, d) is said to be *closed* if F contains all its limit points.

❓ Illustrations of Closed Sets

Verify the following statements concerning closed sets in metric spaces.

1. The empty set $\emptyset$ and the whole space X are closed sets in every metric space (X, d) .
2. On the real line $\mathbb{R}$ with the usual metric, the set $\mathbb{N}$ of natural numbers is closed.
3. The set $\mathbb{Q}$ of rational numbers is not closed in $\mathbb{R}$ with the usual metric.
4. Every closed interval on the real line is a closed set.
5. Every finite subset of a metric space is closed.
6. Let

$$A = \{f \in C[a, b] : f(a) = 1\}.$$

Then A is closed in $C[a, b]$ with respect to the supremum metric.

7. The set

$$\left\{ \frac{1+i}{n} : n \in \mathbb{N} \right\}$$

is neither open nor closed in the complex plane with respect to the usual metric.

Characterization of Closed Sets

Let (X, d) be a metric space. A subset $F \subseteq X$ is closed if and only if its complement $X \setminus F$ is open. 

② Closed Sphere Is a Closed Set

Show that every closed sphere in a metric space (X, d) is a closed set.

Basic Properties of Closed Sets

In any metric space (X, d) ,



1. the intersection of an arbitrary family of closed sets is closed;
2. the union of a finite number of closed sets is closed.

② Union of Infinite Closed Sets May Not Be Closed

Show that the union of an infinite number of closed sets in a metric space need not be closed.

Closure of a Set

Closure

Let A be a subset of a metric space (X, d) . The *closure* of A , denoted by $\overline{A}$, is the set of all adherent points of A , that is,

$$\overline{A} = A \cup A',$$

where A' denotes the set of all limit points of A .

💡 Properties of Closure

Let (X, d) be a metric space and let A, B be any two subsets of X .
Then:

1. $\overline{A}$ is the smallest closed set containing A , that is,

$$\overline{A} = \bigcap \{F : F \text{ is closed and } A \subseteq F\};$$

2. A is closed if and only if $A = \overline{A}$;
3. $A \subseteq B$ implies $\overline{A} \subseteq \overline{B}$;
4. $\overline{A \cup B} = \overline{A} \cup \overline{B}$;
5. $\overline{A \cap B} \subseteq \overline{A} \cap \overline{B}$.
6. $\overline{\overline{A}} = \overline{A}$.
7. $\overline{A} = (\text{ext } A)^c$.
8. $\overline{A} = \text{int}(A^c)^c$.

Interior, Exterior, Frontier and Boundary Points

Interior Point

Let A be a subset of a metric space (X, d) . A point $a \in A$ is called an *interior point* of A if there exists $r > 0$ such that

$$a \in S_r(a) \subseteq A.$$

Interior of a Set

The set of all interior points of A is called the *interior* of A and is denoted by $\text{int } A$, where

$$\text{int } A = \{x \in A : S_r(x) \subseteq A \text{ for some } r > 0\}.$$

Clearly, $\text{int } A$ is an open subset of A .

Exterior Point

A point $x \in X$ is called an *exterior point* of A if it is an interior point of the complement of A , that is, if there exists $r > 0$ such that

$$S_r(x) \subseteq A^c \quad \text{or equivalently} \quad S_r(x) \cap A = \emptyset.$$

Exterior of a Set

The set of all exterior points of A , denoted by $\text{ext } A$, is called the *exterior* of A . By definition,

$$\text{ext } A = \text{int } A^c.$$

Hence $\text{ext } A$ is open and is the largest open set contained in A^c . Moreover,

$$\text{ext } A = (\overline{A})^c.$$

Boundary Point

A point $x \in X$ is called a *boundary point* (or *frontier point*) of A if every open sphere centered at x intersects both A and its complement A^c , that is, for every $r > 0$,

$$S_r(x) \cap A \neq \emptyset \quad \text{and} \quad S_r(x) \cap A^c \neq \emptyset.$$

Boundary of a Set

The set of all boundary points of A is called the *boundary* (or *frontier*) of A and is denoted by ∂A , where

$$\partial A = \overline{A} \setminus \text{int } A.$$

Equivalently,

$$\partial A = \overline{A} \cap \overline{A^c}.$$

② Illustrations of Interior, Exterior, Boundary

Compute the interior, exterior, and boundary of the following subsets.

1. Let $X = \mathbb{R}$ with the usual metric and let $A = \mathbb{Q}$. Then

$$\text{int } A = \emptyset, \quad \text{ext } A = \emptyset, \quad \partial A = \mathbb{R}.$$

2. Let $X = \mathbb{R}$ with the usual metric and let $A = (1, 2) \cup (3, 4)$. Then

$$\text{int } A = A,$$

$$\text{ext } A = (-\infty, 1) \cup (2, 3) \cup (4, \infty),$$

$$\partial A = \{1, 2, 3, 4\}.$$

3. If (X, d) is a discrete metric space and $A \subseteq X$, then

$$\text{int } A = A, \quad \text{ext } A = A^c, \quad \partial A = \emptyset.$$

4. Let $X = \mathbb{N}$ with the usual metric and let $A = \{1, 2, 3\}$. Then

$$\text{int } A = \emptyset, \quad \text{ext } A = \emptyset, \quad \partial A = \mathbb{N}.$$

Properties of Interior

Let A and B be any two subsets of a metric space (X, d) . Then: 

1. $\text{int } A$ is the largest open set contained in A , that is,

$$\text{int } A = \bigcup \{G : G \text{ is open and } G \subseteq A\};$$

2. A is open if and only if $A = \text{int } A$;
3. $A \subseteq B$ implies $\text{int } A \subseteq \text{int } B$;
4. $\text{int}(A \cap B) = \text{int } A \cap \text{int } B$;
5. $\text{int}(A \cup B) \supseteq \text{int } A \cup \text{int } B$.

💡 Properties of Exterior of a Set

Let (X, d) be a metric space and let A, B be any two subsets of X .
Then:

1. $\text{ext } A$ is the largest open set contained in A^c ;
2. A is closed if and only if $A^c = \text{ext } A$;
3. $A \subseteq B$ implies $\text{ext } B \subseteq \text{ext } A$;
4. $\text{ext}(A \cap B) \supseteq \text{ext } A \cup \text{ext } B$;
5. $\text{ext}(A \cup B) = \text{ext } A \cap \text{ext } B$.

💡 Properties of Boundary

Let (X, d) be a metric space, and let A, B be subsets of X . Then:

1. $\partial A = \overline{A} \cap \overline{A^c} = \overline{A} \setminus \text{int } A$;
2. $\partial A = \emptyset$ if and only if A is both open and closed;
3. A is closed if and only if $\partial A \subseteq A$;
4. A is open if and only if $\partial A \subseteq A^c$;
5. $\partial(A \cap B) \subseteq \partial A \cup \partial B$. The equality holds if $\overline{A} \cap \overline{B} = \emptyset$;
6. $\partial(\text{int } A) \subseteq \partial A$.

Thank You!

We'd love your questions and feedback.

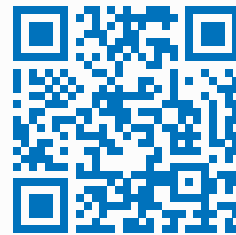
Partho Sutra Dhor

Lecturer, BRAC University, Dhaka-1212

✉ partho.dhor@bracu.ac.bd | ✉ parthosutradhor@gmail.com

 **@ParthoSutraDhor**

(Lectures, walkthroughs, and course updates)



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References

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